

College Lost & Found System

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION & USER MANUAL

Python 3.x

CLI Application

Modular Architecture

Overview

The **College Lost & Found System** is a command-line application built in Python designed to help students and staff efficiently manage lost and found items on campus. The system allows users to report lost items, log found items, search through existing records, and display all active listings via an interactive text-based interface.

Features

- **Report Lost Items:** Log details of items you have lost, including the item name, location, date, and your contact information.
- **Log Found Items:** Record items you have found on campus along with where you found them, the date, and your contact details.
- **Search Functionality:** Quickly look up specific lost or found items by name to match lost goods with finders.
- **Comprehensive Listings:** View formatted lists of all registered lost or found items stored in active sessions.
- **Interactive Menu:** Easy-to-use console interface with a persistent loop for continuous navigation.

Technologies & Tools Used

- **Language:** Python 3.x
- **Architecture:** Modular multi-file design separating logic across specialized scripts:
 - `main.py` : Application entry point and main interaction loop.
 - `lost_item.py` : Handles lost item creation and searches.
 - `found_item.py` : Handles found item logging and searches.
 - `display.py` : Formats and prints active item registries.

Steps to Install & Run the Project

1. **Prerequisites:** Ensure you have Python 3.x installed on your operating system.
2. **Download Files:** Save all project files (`main.py` , `lost_item.py` , `found_item.py` , and `display.py`) into the same local working directory.
3. **Open Terminal:** Launch your preferred terminal or command prompt and navigate to the project directory.
4. **Run Application:** Execute the main execution script using the command below:

```
python main.py
```

Instructions for Testing

1. Launch the application by running `python main.py` in your terminal.
2. From the displayed main menu, select **Option 1** to add a lost item (e.g., enter item name "ID Card", location "Library", date, and contact number).
3. Log a found item using the appropriate system routine (Option 2 setup).
4. Test the search feature by choosing **Option 3** or **Option 4** and entering the target item name.
5. Use **Option 5** and **Option 6** to display all currently recorded lost and found item collections.
6. Test the termination sequence by selecting **Option 7** to exit cleanly.

Screenshots & Preview

Below is a conceptual terminal layout representation of the system menu interface:

```
=====
      COLLEGE LOST & FOUND SYSTEM
=====
1. Add Lost Item
2. Add Found Item
3. Search Lost Item
4. Search Found Item
5. Display Lost Items
6. Display Found Items
7. Exit

Enter your choice:
```